CEOs: that 'agent'? One regex, a 0.6 gate.

A decision test for rules, workflows and agents, with the code behind each branch.

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BRANCH 1 · A RULE

When the bad cases are enumerable.

The humanizer strips AI openers and vocabulary with regular expressions before a single token is spent.

humanizer / humanizer.py

```
RE_OPENING_FLUFF = re.compile(
    r"^(Certainly!?|Absolutely!?|Great question!?
  |Sure!|Of course!?|"
…
RE_EM_DASH = re.compile(r"\s*[—–]\s*")
…
    "delve", "leverage", "robust", "comprehensive", "key
  takeaways",
```

BRANCH 2 · A WORKFLOW

When the steps are known, only the judgement is fuzzy.

Email triage buckets each message with a small decision model. Under 0.6 confidence, or any error, a person gets it.

google / jev_email_gate.py

```
def route(bucket, confidence, is_scam, human_sent,
  min_confidence=0.6, error=None):
    if error or not bucket:
        return "human"
    if is_scam ⩾ SCAM_THRESHOLD:
        return "human" if human_sent ⩾
  HUMAN_SENT_THRESHOLD else "archive_or_skip"
    if confidence < min_confidence:
        return "human"
    if bucket in AGENT_BUCKETS:
        return "agent"
    return "archive_or_skip"
```

BRANCH 3 · AN AGENT

Only when the steps are not known in advance.

And only when a wrong step is recoverable. The model client retries once on a rate limit, then fails open with an error field. It never raises.

modules / jev_client.py

```
"""Ask Jev every question in `questions` about `state`
  in ONE request.

HTTP 429 sleeps min(retry-after or 1 s, 5 s) and retries
  once.
Fails open: any exception, HTTP error or malformed body
  returns a JevResult with
`error` set and empty answers. Never raises.
"""
```

EVERY BRANCH

One human check closes each branch.

Sometimes a rule, an API call and one human check are enough.

Which branch did your last AI project actually need, and which one did the vendor sell you?